



Basic Emergency Care

Ethics of the Rescuer

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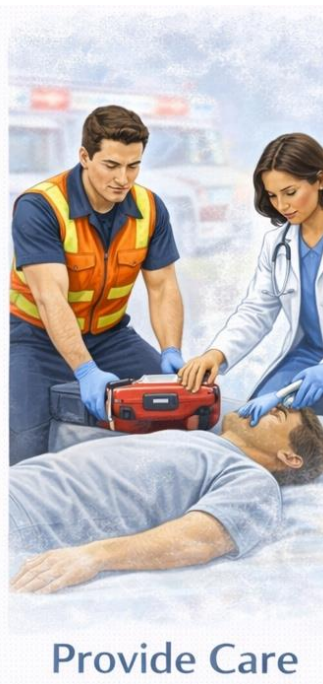
Ethics in Emergency Care

- Ethics are moral principles guiding behavior in healthcare.
- They are especially important during emergencies where decisions are made under stress.
- Ethics protect patient dignity, rights, and trust.



Responsibilities of the Rescuer

- Preserve life whenever possible.
- Reduce suffering.
- Respect patient dignity.



Respect for Life

- Every human life has equal value.
- Care must be provided without discrimination.
- Decisions should remain objective and fair.



Four Principles of Medical Ethics



Autonomy



Beneficence



Non-Maleficence



Justice

Beneficence

- Act in the patient's best interest.
- Provide timely and appropriate care.
- Aim to promote patient well-being.



Non-Maleficence

- Do no harm.
- Avoid unnecessary risk.
- Recognize personal limits and stop when required.

“First, do no harm.”

Act carefully, avoid unnecessary risk, and never let your intervention cause further injury.



Consent in Emergencies

- Unconscious patients are treated under implied consent.
- Life-saving care is ethically justified.
- Explain actions whenever possible.



Refusal of Care

- A conscious patient has the right to refuse treatment.
- Explain risks clearly.
- Document refusal when possible.



Confidentiality

- Patient information must be protected.
- Only share information with involved healthcare providers.
- Maintain privacy even in emergency situations.



Professional Behavior

- Remain calm and respectful.
- Avoid judgment or blame.
- Maintain professional conduct under stress.



R.E.S.P.E.C.T.

Respect

Ethics

Sensitivity

Professionalism

Empathy

Communication

Trustworthiness



Respect



Ethics



Sensitivity



Communication



Communication



Trustworthiness

Cultural Sensitivity

- Respect cultural and religious beliefs.
- Avoid assumptions.
- Communicate respectfully.



Ethical Dilemmas

- Limited resources may require prioritization.
- Triage decisions must be fair and objective.
- Ethical principles guide difficult choices.



Legal Protection

- Act in good faith.
- Follow institutional guidelines.
- Document care when possible.



When to Stop Care

- When the scene becomes unsafe.
- When advanced care arrives.
- When continuing care is no longer beneficial.



Key Ethical Messages

- Respect, safety, and responsibility guide care.
- Ethics are inseparable from emergency medicine.



Respect Autonomy

Honor patient decisions
and informed consent



Do No Harm

Avoid causing unnecessary
harm or suffering



Prioritize Well-Being

Act in the best interest
of your patient's health



Ensure Justice

Treat patients fairly
without discrimination

Resources & Further Reading

World Health Organization (WHO). Basic Emergency Care: Approach to the Acutely Ill and Injured.

American College of Surgeons. Advanced Trauma Life Support (ATLS) – Student Course Manual.

Tintinalli JE. Tintinalli's Emergency Medicine: A Comprehensive Study Guide.

Oxford Handbook of Emergency Medicine.

WHO. Emergency Care Systems Framework.